

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - CSAT Paper II

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

INSTRUCTIONS

1. This paper contains 80 questions and is qualifying with a minimum standard of 33 percent.
2. Each correct response carries 2.5 marks; one-third of the marks assigned to a question (shown as 0.83) is deducted for an incorrect response; an attempted question carries zero.
3. Use only the information given in comprehension and data-sufficiency questions.

Q1. Passage: A district digitised land records, but dispute resolution did not improve until maps, mutation registers and field verification were reconciled. Technology reduced search time; it could not decide contested title by itself. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A. Digitisation improves access but cannot replace legal and field reconciliation. | B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. |
| C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. | D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. |

Q2. Passage: A district digitised land records, but dispute resolution did not improve until maps, mutation registers and field verification were reconciled. Technology reduced search time; it could not decide contested title by itself. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. | B. Faster retrieval and accurate adjudication are different outcomes. |
| C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. | D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. |

Q3. Passage: A district digitised land records, but dispute resolution did not improve until maps, mutation registers and field verification were reconciled. Technology reduced search time; it could not decide contested title by itself. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. | B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. |
| C. Citizens contesting title require records that refer to the same parcel. | D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. |

Q4. Passage: A district digitised land records, but dispute resolution did not improve until maps, mutation registers and field verification were reconciled. Technology reduced search time; it could not decide contested title by itself. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

- | | |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. unreservedly celebratory | B. hostile and dismissive |
| C. unrelated and indifferent | D. qualified and analytical |

Q5. Passage: A self-help group began collective procurement of seed. Costs fell, yet the poorest members benefited only after instalment payments were allowed. Scale created efficiency; payment design determined inclusion. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A. Collective buying needs inclusive payment design to share its gains. | B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. |
|---|---|

C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter.	D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input.
--	---

Q6. Passage: A self-help group began collective procurement of seed. Costs fell, yet the poorest members benefited only after instalment payments were allowed. Scale created efficiency; payment design determined inclusion. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances.	B. Lower unit cost alone need not make an input affordable.
C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes.	D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory.

Q7. Passage: A self-help group began collective procurement of seed. Costs fell, yet the poorest members benefited only after instalment payments were allowed. Scale created efficiency; payment design determined inclusion. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition.	B. No alternative explanation can ever exist.
C. Some poorer members faced a liquidity constraint.	D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources.

Q8. Passage: A self-help group began collective procurement of seed. Costs fell, yet the poorest members benefited only after instalment payments were allowed. Scale created efficiency; payment design determined inclusion. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory	B. hostile and dismissive
C. unrelated and indifferent	D. balanced

Q9. Passage: A city planted roadside trees but survival remained low where contracts rewarded planting rather than maintenance. When payments were linked to three-year survival, contractors changed species choice and watering schedules. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Outcome-linked contracts can improve urban tree survival.	B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting.
C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter.	D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input.

Q10. Passage: A city planted roadside trees but survival remained low where contracts rewarded planting rather than maintenance. When payments were linked to three-year survival, contractors changed species choice and watering schedules. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances.	B. Incentives influenced maintenance and species choice.
C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes.	D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory.

Q11. Passage: A city planted roadside trees but survival remained low where contracts rewarded planting rather than maintenance. When payments were linked to three-year survival, contractors changed species choice and watering schedules. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition.	B. No alternative explanation can ever exist.
C. Survival can be measured reliably enough to affect payment.	D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources.

Q12. Passage: A city planted roadside trees but survival remained low where contracts rewarded planting rather than maintenance. When payments were linked to three-year survival, contractors changed species choice and watering schedules. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited

equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory	B. hostile and dismissive
C. unrelated and indifferent	D. evidence-based

Q13. Passage: A school served breakfast before morning classes. Attendance rose, but learning gains were largest where teachers also used short diagnostic exercises. Nutrition improved readiness; instruction converted readiness into learning. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Nutrition and responsive teaching work as complements.	B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting.
C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter.	D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input.

Q14. Passage: A school served breakfast before morning classes. Attendance rose, but learning gains were largest where teachers also used short diagnostic exercises. Nutrition improved readiness; instruction converted readiness into learning. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances.	B. Attendance gains do not automatically equal learning gains.
C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes.	D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory.

Q15. Passage: A school served breakfast before morning classes. Attendance rose, but learning gains were largest where teachers also used short diagnostic exercises. Nutrition improved readiness; instruction converted readiness into learning. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition.	B. No alternative explanation can ever exist.
C. Diagnostic exercises helped teachers adapt instruction.	D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources.

Q16. Passage: A school served breakfast before morning classes. Attendance rose, but learning gains were largest where teachers also used short diagnostic exercises. Nutrition improved readiness; instruction converted readiness into learning. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory	B. hostile and dismissive
C. unrelated and indifferent	D. measured

Q17. Passage: A coastal village received cyclone warnings in time, yet evacuation lagged until local volunteers translated the message into landmarks and arranged transport for older residents. Forecast accuracy mattered, but last-mile trust and capability completed the warning chain. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Early warning succeeds only when trusted last-mile action is possible.	B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting.
C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter.	D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input.

Q18. Passage: A coastal village received cyclone warnings in time, yet evacuation lagged until local volunteers translated the message into landmarks and arranged transport for older residents. Forecast accuracy mattered, but last-mile trust and capability completed the warning chain. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances.	B. Technical forecasts can fail to produce evacuation without local capability.
C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes.	D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory.

Q19. Passage: A coastal village received cyclone warnings in time, yet evacuation lagged until local volunteers translated the message into landmarks and arranged transport for older residents. Forecast accuracy mattered, but last-mile trust and capability completed the warning chain. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition.	B. No alternative explanation can ever exist.
C. Residents understood and trusted locally translated guidance.	D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources.

Q20. Passage: A coastal village received cyclone warnings in time, yet evacuation lagged until local volunteers translated the message into landmarks and arranged transport for older residents. Forecast accuracy mattered, but last-mile trust and capability completed the warning chain. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory	B. hostile and dismissive
C. unrelated and indifferent	D. cautionary

Q21. What is the remainder when $154^2 + 3 \times 154 + 5$ is divided by 8?

A. 7	B. 0
C. 1	D. 2

Q22. Two numbers are obtained by doubling 20 and tripling 33. What is their HCF?

A. 2	B. 1
C. 3	D. 3960

Q23. How many positive divisors does 36 have?

A. 8	B. 10
C. 9	D. 6

Q24. What is the unit digit of $(4^{12}) \times (8^6)$?

A. 5	B. 6
C. 7	D. 4

Q25. The arithmetic sequence begins 4, 7, 10. What is the sum of its first 9 terms?

A. 144.0	B. 141.0
C. 147.0	D. 28

Q26. After multiplying 9987 by 9, what is the sum of the decimal digits of the product?

A. 35	B. 36
C. 37	D. 38

Q27. How many integers from 16 through 122, inclusive, are divisible by 7 but not by 14?

A. 7	B. 9
C. 8	D. 10

Q28. The values are 13, 19, 25, 31. If the smallest falls by 1 and the largest rises by 2, what is the new mean?

A. 22.0	B. 23.25
C. 24.25	D. 22.25

Q29. If $3x + 2 = 20$, what is x ?

A. 6	B. 5
C. 7	D. 18

Q30. If $2(x - 1) = 8$, what is x when x is a positive integer and the displayed equality is supplemented by $x + 1 = 6$?

A. 4	B. 5
C. 6	D. 10

Q31. The sum of two consecutive integers is 19. What is the smaller integer?

A. 10	B. 8
C. 9	D. 19

Q32. Five years ago A was half of A's age 12 years from now. What is A's present age?

A. 17	B. 27
C. 11	D. 22

Q33. What is the positive solution of $x^2 = 49$?

A. 7	B. -7
C. 49	D. 8

Q34. Which value is the least integer satisfying $2x + 1 > 16$?

A. 7	B. 8
C. 9	D. 16

Q35. A grant equals 15% of Rs 280. An administrative surcharge of 6% is then applied to the grant. What is the final amount?

A. 42	B. 38.52
C. 44.52	D. 58.8

Q36. A value of 1000 rises by 9% and then falls by 4%. What is the final value?

A. 1050	B. 1050.0
C. 1056.4	D. 1046.4

Q37. Rs 480 is divided in the ratio 3:3. What is the first share?

A. 240.0	B. 237.0
C. 243.0	D. 80.0

Q38. Groups of 21 and 31 have averages 41 and 61. What is their combined average?

A. 51.0	B. 52.92
C. 51.92	D. 53.92

Q39. An article costs Rs 550, is marked for a 16% profit, and then receives a 5% rebate on that marked selling price. What is the realised price?

A. 638.0	B. 610.5
C. 606.1	D. 611.1

Q40. A marked price of Rs 900 is discounted by 11%. What is the sale price?

A. 889	B. 999.0
C. 790.0	D. 801.0

Q41. A mixture contains milk and water in the ratio 4:5. In 36 litres, how many litres are milk?

A. 16.0	B. 15.0
---------	---------

C. 4.0	D. 17.0
--------	---------

Q42. The average of 6 values is 41. After adding 53, what is the new average?

A. 41	B. 42.71
C. 47.0	D. 43.71

Q43. A can finish a task in 9 days and B in 13 days. How many days will they take together?

A. 22	B. 11.0
C. 5.32	D. 4

Q44. 13 workers finish a job in 15 days at equal efficiency. How many days will 19 workers take?

A. 15	B. 21.92
C. 11.26	D. 10.26

Q45. Two pipes fill a tank in 7 and 9 hours. If opened together, how long do they take?

A. 3.94	B. 16
C. 8.0	D. 4.94

Q46. An inlet fills a tank in 6 hours while a leak empties it in 21 hours. How long to fill together?

A. 4.67	B. 8.4
C. 15	D. 6

Q47. A is 3 times as efficient as B. If B alone takes 30 days, how many days does A take?

A. 30	B. 3
C. 10	D. 13

Q48. A team completes 0.37 of a job. What fraction remains, rounded to two decimals?

A. 0.37	B. 1.37
C. 0.73	D. 0.63

Q49. A vehicle's total journey time is 4 hours, including a halt of 15 minutes. It moves at 50 km/h whenever in motion. What distance is covered?

A. 187.5	B. 200
C. 137.5	D. 237.5

Q50. Over 260 km, how many hours are saved by increasing speed from 41 to 61 km/h?

A. 13.0	B. 2.08
C. 3.08	D. 1.08

Q51. A 190-metre train moves at 54 km/h. How many seconds does it take to clear a 95-metre platform?

A. 12.67	B. 21.0
C. 19.0	D. 17.0

Q52. A boat's still-water speed is 11 km/h and stream speed is 3 km/h. How long does it take to travel 16 km upstream?

A. 1.1428571428571428	B. 8
C. 1.4545454545454546	D. 2

Q53. A runner completes 4 laps of a square field of side 21 m in 8 minutes. What is the runner's speed in metres per minute?

A. 42.0	B. 84
C. 55.125	D. 21.0

Q54. A car covers 120 km at 41 km/h and 180 km at 61 km/h. What is average speed?

A. 51.0	B. 51.04
C. 53.04	D. 49.04

Q55. A table reports district outputs (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127). What is the total?

A. 414	B. 434
C. 424	D. 127

Q56. Using the table (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127), what is the difference between the highest and lowest values?

A. 127	B. 85
C. 212	D. 42

Q57. Using the table (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127), what is the average of the four values?

A. 106.0	B. 424
C. 212.0	D. 42

Q58. Using the table (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127), by what percentage does D exceed A?

A. 33.07	B. 49.41
C. 42	D. 149.41

Q59. Year 1 values are A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127; Year 2 values are A=106, B=115, C=124, D=133. Which district has the largest absolute increase?

A. B	B. C
C. A	D. D

Q60. Using Year 2 (A=106, B=115, C=124, D=133), what fraction of the total belongs to B, rounded to two decimals?

A. 0.27	B. 4.16
C. 0.22	D. 0.24

Q61. Using Year 1 (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127), if each unit earns Rs 3, what is D's revenue?

A. 381	B. 130
C. 127	D. 1272

Q62. Using Year 1 (A=85, B=99, C=113, D=127), what is the ratio A:D in simplest form?

A. 127:85	B. 85:127
C. 170:254	D. 212:1

Q63. All auditors are trained. No person lacking that status may certify. Which conclusion necessarily follows?

A. Every trained person is one of the auditors.	B. Some auditors lack that status.
C. Every auditor is outside the class lacking that status.	D. No trained person may certify.

Q64. If each letter is shifted forward by 1, how is INDIA coded?

A. INDIA	B. BJEOJ
C. JODJB	D. JOEJB

Q65. Complete the series: 3, 5, 9, 15, ?

A. 23	B. 22
C. 24	D. 21

Q66. Mira is the child of Arun's only son. How is Mira related to Arun?

A. Child	B. Grandchild
C. Niece or nephew	D. Sibling

Q67. Some books are reports. All reports are archived. Which conclusion follows?

A. All books are archived	B. No books are archived
C. Some books are archived	D. Some archived are not reports

Q68. In a code, GOVERN is written as HPWFSO by shifting each letter forward once. How is STATE written?

A. STATE	B. FUBUT
C. AAAAA	D. TUBUF

Q69. A, B, C and D sit in a row. A is left of B; C is right of B; D is left of A. Who is second from the left?

A. A	B. B
C. C	D. D

Q70. Four tasks P, Q, R and S occur consecutively. P precedes Q; R follows Q; S precedes P. Which task is third?

A. P	B. Q
C. R	D. S

Q71. Five persons stand by height. K is taller than L but shorter than M. N is shorter than L. O is taller than M. Who is tallest?

A. M	B. K
C. O	D. N

Q72. Review is after Finance but before Health. Education is before Finance. Which is earliest?

A. Finance	B. Review
C. Health	D. Education

Q73. A person faces North and turns right 1 time(s), each by 90 degrees. Which direction is faced?

A. East	B. North
C. South	D. West

Q74. A walker goes 3 km north and 4 km east. How far is the endpoint from the start?

A. 7 km	B. 5 km
C. 1 km	D. 12 km

Q75. A person starts facing East, turns left, then turns left again. Which direction is now faced?

A. North	B. East
C. West	D. South

Q76. A point B is 5 km south of A, and C is 5 km east of B. In which direction is C from A?

A. North-East	B. South-West
C. North-West	D. South-East

Q77. What is x? Statement 1: $x+3=10$. Statement 2: $2x=14$.

A. Each statement alone is sufficient.	B. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not.
C. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not.	D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient.

Q78. What is the area of a rectangle? Statement 1: its length is 8 cm. Statement 2: its breadth is 5 cm.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not.	B. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient.
C. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not.	D. Each statement alone is sufficient.

Q79. Is integer n even? Statement 1: n is divisible by 8. Statement 2: n is divisible by 4.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not.	B. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not.
---	---

C. Each statement alone is sufficient.	D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient.
--	--

Q80. What is y ? Statement 1: y is positive. Statement 2: $y^2=49$.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not.	B. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not.
C. Each statement alone is sufficient.	D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient.

END OF PAPER